

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12400327
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	August 26, 2025
Inventor(s)	Sadri; Amir Reza et al.

Hybrid convolutional wavelet networks for predicting treatment response via radiological images of bowel disease

Abstract

In some embodiments, the present disclosure relates to a non-transitory computer-readable medium storing computer-executable instructions that, when executed, cause a processor to perform operations, including forming an imaging dataset having imaging data corresponding to one or more radiological images of a patient having a bowel disease; operating upon the imaging data with one or more convolutional neural network (CNN) segments configured to generate a plurality of CNN outputs, the one or more CNN segments respectively including a convolution layer configured to perform a convolution on the imaging data; and applying a wavelet network to the plurality of CNN outputs to generate a plurality of convolution wavelet network (CWN) outputs, the wavelet network being configured to decompose the plurality of CNN outputs according to a mother wavelet. A predictive signature associated with disease response or risk is constructed using the plurality of CWN outputs.

Inventors: Sadri; Amir Reza (Cleveland Heights, OH), Viswanath; Satish E. (Beachwood, OH), Desilvio; Thomas (Lyndhurst, OH)

Applicant: Case Western Reserve University (Cleveland, OH)

Family ID: 1000008778071

Assignee: Case Western Resereve University (Cleveland, OH)

Appl. No.: 18/169935

Filed: February 16, 2023

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20230267607 A1	Aug. 24, 2023

Related U.S. Application Data

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: **G06T7/00** (20170101); **G16H30/40** (20180101); **G16H50/30** (20180101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **G06T7/0012** (20130101); **G16H30/40** (20180101); **G16H50/30** (20180101);
G06T2207/10072 (20130101); G06T2207/10116 (20130101); G06T2207/20064
(20130101); G06T2207/20084 (20130101); G06T2207/30028 (20130101);
G06T2207/30096 (20130101)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: G06T (7/0012); G06T (2207/10081); G06T (2207/10088); G06T (2207/10116); G06T
(2207/20064); G06T (2207/20084); G06T (2207/30028); G06T (2207/30096); G06H
(30/20); G06H (30/40); G16H (50/20); G16H (50/30); A61B (5/4255); A61B (5/7275);
A61B (5/7264-7267)

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
11120312	12/2020	Buckler	N/A	G06F 18/29
2020/0380673	12/2019	Wang	N/A	G06T 7/0012

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

Fujieda, Shin, Kohei Takayama, and Toshiya Hachisuka. "Wavelet convolutional neural networks." arXiv preprint arXiv:1805.08620 (Year: 2018). cited by examiner

Khatami, Amin, et al. "Convolutional neural network for medical image classification using wavelet features." 2020 international joint conference on neural networks (IJCNN). IEEE, (Year: 2020). cited by examiner

Sadri, Amir Reza, et al. "Residual wavelon convolutional networks for characterization of disease response on MRI." International Conference on Medical Image Computing and Computer-Assisted Intervention. Cham: Springer Nature Switzerland, pp. 366-375 (Year: 2022). cited by examiner

Yamashita, Rikiya, et al. "Convolutional neural networks: an overview and application in radiology." Insights into imaging 9, pp. 611-629 (Year: 2018). cited by examiner

Primary Examiner: Rogers; Scott A

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Eschweiler & Potashnik, LLC

Background/Summary

REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION (1) This application claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/311,468, filed on Feb. 18, 2022, the contents of which are hereby

incorporated by reference in their entirety.

BACKGROUND

(1) Deep learning is a type of machine learning that works with artificial neural networks, which are designed to imitate how humans think and learn. In recent years, deep learning technology has found applications in many fields, including medical imaging.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The accompanying drawings, which are incorporated in and constitute a part of the specification, illustrate various example operations, apparatus, methods, and other example embodiments of various aspects discussed herein. It will be appreciated that the illustrated element boundaries (e.g., boxes, groups of boxes, or other shapes) in the figures represent one example of the boundaries. One of ordinary skill in the art will appreciate that, in some examples, one element can be designed as multiple elements or that multiple elements can be designed as one element. In some examples, an element shown as an internal component of another element may be implemented as an external component and vice versa. Furthermore, elements may not be drawn to scale.

(2) FIG. 1 illustrates a block diagram showing some embodiments of a convolutional wavelet network (CWN) comprising one or more wavelet networks (WNs) integrated within a convolutional neural network (CNN) architecture.

(3) FIG. 2 illustrates a block diagram showing some additional embodiments of a CWN comprising one or more WNs integrated within a CNN architecture.

(4) FIGS. 3A-3B illustrate block diagrams showing some embodiments of a disclosed WN.

(5) FIG. 4 illustrates a block diagram showing some additional embodiments of a CWN comprising one or more WNs integrated within a CNN architecture.

(6) FIG. 5 illustrates a block diagram showing some additional embodiments of a CWN comprising one or more WNs integrated within a CNN architecture.

(7) FIGS. 6A-6B illustrate block diagrams showing some additional embodiments of a CWN comprising one or more WNs integrated within a CNN architecture.

(8) FIG. 7 illustrates a method of performing image analysis using a disclosed CWN having one or more WNs integrated with a CNN architecture.

(9) FIG. 8 illustrates a block diagram showing some embodiments of a medical image analysis system comprising a disclosed CWN.

(10) FIG. 9 illustrates a flow diagram showing a method of performing analysis of a radiological image using a disclosed CWN.

(11) FIG. 10 illustrates a table showing example performance parameters of a disclosed DHCWN in comparison to different machine learning models operated for distinguishing a pathologic complete response (pCR) from a non-pCR.

(12) FIG. 11 illustrates exemplary images showing Grad-CAM heatmaps overlaid on pCR tumor ROI and non-pCR tumor ROI.

(13) FIGS. 12A-12B illustrate tables showing example performance parameters of disclosed DHCWNs having different Mother wavelets in comparison to different machine learning models operated to distinguish a pCR from a non-pCR.

(14) FIG. 13A illustrates exemplary images showing Grad-CAM heatmaps overlaid on pCR tumor ROI and non-pCR tumor ROI.

(15) FIG. 13B illustrates exemplary images showing Kernel Shapley Additive exPlanation (SNAP) maps overlaid on pCR tumor ROI and non-pCR tumor ROI.

(16) FIG. 14 illustrates a table showing exemplary performance parameters for disclosed RWCNs

in comparison to different machine learning models architectures in distinguishing pCR from non-pCR for different diseases.

(17) FIG. 15 illustrates a flow diagram of some additional embodiments of a method of generating and applying a disclosed CWN to a patient.

(18) FIG. 16 illustrates a block diagram of some embodiments of an apparatus comprising a CWN that is configured to determine a prognosis for a patient.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(19) The description herein is made with reference to the drawings, wherein like reference numerals are generally utilized to refer to like elements throughout, and wherein the various structures are not necessarily drawn to scale. In the following description, for purposes of explanation, numerous specific details are set forth in order to facilitate understanding. It may be evident, however, to one of ordinary skill in the art, that one or more aspects described herein may be practiced with a lesser degree of these specific details. In other instances, known structures and devices are shown in block diagram form to facilitate understanding.

(20) Convolutional neural networks (CNNs) are a type of machine learning classifier that is commonly used in the analysis of images and/or audio signals. CNNs may be configured to receive an input image, assign importance (e.g., via learnable weights) to different features in the input image, and use the learnable weights to differentiate the different features from one another.

(21) The basic architecture of a CNN comprises three different layers: a convolution layer, a pooling layer, and a fully connected layer. The convolution layer is configured to receive an input image and to perform a convolution on the input image to generate convolved data. The pooling layer is configured to down-sample the convolved data to form a feature map, which may identify features (e.g., edges, corners, etc.) within the input image. The fully connected layer uses an activation function to map the feature map into final outputs that can be used to classify the input image.

(22) In recent years, CNNs have found increased use within medical applications. For example, CNNs may be used to identify features within medical images of a patient (e.g., radiological images, digitized images, etc.), and to subsequently use the features to make a prognosis relating to the patient. While the use of CNNs has been moderately successful in analyzing medical images, there are still many medical applications (e.g., rectal cancer, Crohn's disease, etc.) in which CNNs have failed to accurately diagnose patients. This may be because activation functions used by CNNs to generate final outputs are fixed (e.g., monotonic) functions that may be unstable due to infinite energy levels (e.g., in a ReLU function of a ResNET model).

(23) Wavelets are wave-like oscillations that can be varied in scale and time. A wavelet transform is a projection of a signal into a set of wavelets (e.g., de-composing a signal into shifted and scaled versions of a mother wavelet). For example, during a wavelet transform a function can be approximated by adding different versions of a mother wavelet having varying scales and time shifts. It has been appreciated that the use of wavelets as an activation function of a CNN architecture may lead to improved characterization of a medical image, thereby improving an ability of health care professionals to capture subtle patterns within the medical image.

(24) The present disclosure relates to a convolutional wavelet network (CWN) that utilizes both deep learning (e.g., convolutional neural networks) and wavelet networks to generate a predictive signature from a digitized image of a patient. In some embodiments, the disclosed CWN comprises one or more CNN segments configured to operate upon an input image of a patient having a bowel disease (e.g., rectal cancer, Crohn's disease, etc.) to generate a plurality of CNN outputs. The plurality of CNN outputs are provided as inputs to a wavelet network. The wavelet network is configured to perform a wavelet decomposition on the plurality of CNN outputs to generate a plurality of CWN outputs that can be used to construct a predictive signature of the bowel disease for the patient. Unlike the fixed and/or monotonic activation functions that are commonly used in convolutional neural networks (CNNs), the disclosed CWN uses a wavelet network to operate as a

flexible activation function. Therefore, the disclosed CWN may be able to capture more complex structures from medical images and thereby aid health care professionals in identifying features that have a high correlation to a prognosis (e.g., a pathologic complete response (pCR) of a patient). For example, the disclosed CWN may exploit subtle differences in oriented and scaled textures that may allow differentiation between tumors (e.g., lesions) which do or do not respond to chemoradiation.

(25) FIG. 1 illustrates a block diagram showing some embodiments of an image analysis system **100** comprising a convolutional wavelet network (CWN) having one or more wavelet networks (WNs) integrated within a convolutional neural network (CNN) architecture.

(26) The image analysis system **100** comprises a CWN **104** configured to receive an input image **102**. The input image **102** comprises a plurality of pixels or voxels respectively having an associated intensity. In some embodiments, the input image **102** may comprise a radiological image (e.g., a magnetic resonance image (MRI), a computed tomography (CT) image, magnetic resonance elastography (MRE), or the like) of a patient having a disease (e.g., a bowel disease such a rectal cancer, Crohn's disease, or the like).

(27) The CWN **104** comprises one or more convolutional neural network (CNN) segments **106** (e.g., sequence blocks) and one or more wavelet networks (WNs) **114**. The one or more CNN segments **106** are configured to operate upon the input image **102** to generate a plurality of CNN outputs **107**. The plurality of CNN outputs **107** may correspond to one or more features (e.g., texture patterns, shapes, edges, or the like) of the input image **102**. The one or more CNN segments **106** may respectively comprise one or more convolution layers **108** configured to perform a convolution upon the input image **102** to generate a feature map. The feature map may be subsequently acted on by a rectification layer **110** (e.g., configured to apply a nonlinear activation function, such as rectified linear activation function (ReLU), exponential linear unit (ELU), Leaky ReLU variants, or the like) and/or a pooling layer **112** to generate the plurality of CNN outputs **107**.

(28) The plurality of CNN outputs **107** are provided from one of the one or more CNN segments **106** to the one or more WNs **114**. The one or more WNs **114** may be disposed downstream of the one or more CNN segments **106**, so as to act as a final activation layer within the CWN **104**. The one or more wavelet networks **114** are configured to decompose the one or more CNN outputs **107** according to a mother wavelet into a plurality of wavelons. The plurality of wavelons are fully connected to generate one or more CWN outputs **116**. In some embodiments, the one or more CNN outputs **107** may be expanded according to the function $f(x) = \sum_{i=1}^N w_{sub.i} \Psi_{sub.i}(x)$ where $w_{sub.i}$ are decomposition coefficients (e.g., weight, scale, shift, bias, etc.) and $\Psi_{sub.i}(x)$ is a mother wavelet. For example, the one or more wavelet networks **108** may be configured to expand the one or more CNN outputs **107** according to shifted and/or scaled versions of the mother wavelet. In some embodiment, the one or more wavelet networks **114** may respectively comprise a three-layer network comprising an input layer, a hidden layer, and an output layer. The input layer comprises variables corresponding to the one or more CNN outputs **107**. The hidden layer comprises a plurality of wavelons (e.g., wavelet neurons), which respectively comprise different versions of a mother wavelet (e.g., shifted and/or scaled versions of a mother wavelet). The output layer comprises CWN outputs **116** that may be used to classify the input image **102**.

(29) In some embodiments, the plurality of CWN outputs **116** may be used to generate a predictive signature **118** relating to the disease of the patient. In some embodiments, the predictive signature may relate a response of the disease to treatment (e.g., distinguishing a pCR from a non-pCR), thereby indicating whether the patient may need a treatment plan including pharmaceutical therapy or surgery. In other embodiments, the predictive signature may relate a risk of the disease (e.g., a risk of recurrence after treatment, an overall survival of the patient, etc.).

(30) Because the one or more wavelet networks **114** utilize a mother wavelet that is a variable (e.g., non-monotonic) function, the CWN **104** may be able to capture more complicated patterns within the input image **102** (e.g., in comparison to a CNN comprising a fixed activation function). The

ability to capture more complicated patterns within the input image **102** may allow for the disclosed CWN **104** to more accurately identify features that may be used to generate the predictive signature **118** and to thus more accurately indicate a prognosis of a patient. For example, in evaluating pre-treatment rectal cancer MRI scans to predict a pathologic complete response (pCR) of a patient to neoadjuvant chemoradiation, the disclosed CWN **104** yielded a predictive signature with significantly better performance compared to a typical convolutional neural network (CNN) and/or a multilayer wavelet perceptron (DWN-MLP).

(31) FIG. 2 illustrates a block diagram showing some additional embodiments of an image analysis system **200** comprising a CWN having one or more wavelet networks integrated within a CNN architecture.

(32) The image analysis system **200** comprises a CWN **104** having one or more CNN segments **106** configured to receive an input image **102** comprising a plurality of pixels or voxels. In some embodiments, the input image **102** may comprise a radiological image of a patient. In some embodiments, the patient may have a bowel disease (e.g., colorectal cancer, rectal cancer, Crohn's disease, or the like). In some embodiments, the input image **102** may comprise a radiological image having a region of interest including one or more lesions (e.g., tumors). The input image **102** may have an image size that is 50 pixels×50 pixels, 62 pixels×62 pixels, or other similar values.

(33) The one or more CNN segments **106** comprise a first CNN segment **106a** and a second CNN segment **106b** downstream of the first CNN segment **106a**. The first CNN segment **106a** comprises a first convolution layer **108a** configured to perform a convolution, a first rectification layer **110a** configured to perform a rectification function (e.g., a RELU function) on an output of the first convolution layer **108a**, and a first pooling layer **112a** configured to down sample the output of the first rectification layer **110a**. The second CNN segment **106b** comprises a second convolution layer **108b** configured to perform a convolution, a second rectification layer **110b** configured to perform a ReLU rectification function on an output of the second convolution layer **108b**, and a second pooling layer **112b** configured to down sample the output of the second rectification layer **110b**. One or more CNN outputs are output from a last one of the one or more CNN segments **106**.

(34) In some embodiments, convolution layers **108a-108b** may be configured to perform a convolution by acting upon an input matrix with a kernel. In such embodiments, the kernel is operated to slide along the input matrix to generate a feature map. In some embodiments, the first convolution layer **108a** may have a kernel size of 5 (e.g., a 5×5 matrix) and a stride length of 1. In some embodiments, the first pooling layer **112a** may have a kernel size of 2 (e.g., a 2×2 matrix), a stride of length 2, a padding of 0, and a dilation of 1. In some embodiments, the second convolution layer **108b** may have a kernel size of 5 and a stride length of 1. In some embodiments, the second pooling layer **112b** may have a kernel size of 2 (e.g., a 2×2 matrix), a stride of length 2, a padding of 0, and a dilation of 1.

(35) The one or more CNN outputs are provided to one or more WNs **114** disposed downstream of the one or more CNN segments **106**. The one or more WNs **114** may respectively comprise an input layer, one or more hidden layers, and an output layer. The one or more hidden layers respectively comprise wavelet neurons (wavelons), which include shifted and scaled versions of a mother wavelet. In some embodiments, the CWN **104** may comprise a residual wavelon convolutional network (RWCN) including one or more WNs **114** having skip connections extending between the input layer and the output layer. The skip connections are configured to enable residual learning. The residual learning enables the CWN to more efficiently capture high-dimensional disease response-specific patterns from medical images. In other embodiments, the CWN may comprise a deep hybrid convolutional wavelet network (DHCWN) including one or more WNs **114** without skip connections.

(36) In some embodiments, the one or more WNs **114** respectively comprise wavelons that are subject to four different decomposition coefficients: a wavelon weight, a wavelon bias, a wavelon shift, and a wavelon scale. To decrease a complexity of calculations within the one or more WNs,

the decomposition coefficients (e.g., weight, scale, shift, bias) may be defined in a tensor-based actions. For example, a tensor used within the one or more WNs may comprise different components respectively corresponding to a different decomposition coefficient. Using tensor-based actions reduces a time that it takes for the one or more WNs to operated (e.g., a time that it takes to apply a new activation function or pre-defined layer).

(37) Typically, wavelet networks comprise three hidden layers. In some embodiments, the one or more WNs **114** may comprise four or more hidden layers. This is because function complexity dictates selection of a number of wavelons in a hidden layer (e.g., so that as problem complexity increases, a number of wavelons also increases). By increasing a number of hidden layers in the one or more WNs **114** to be greater than three, the number of wavelons in each hidden layer can be kept lower, thereby decreasing complexity of the one or more WNs **114**. By decreasing a complexity of the one or more WNs **114**, the one or more WNs **114** do not suffer from wavelet initialization and/or training complications that typically limit the applications of wavelet networks to low dimensional problems.

(38) In some embodiments, the one or more WNs **114** may comprise a first WN **114a**, a second WN **114b**, and a third WN **114c** sequentially coupled to one another. An input layer of the first WN **114a** comprises variables corresponding to the one or more CNN outputs. An output layer of the third WN **114c** comprises CWN outputs, which may be used to classify the input image **102**. By sequentially coupling the one or more WNs **114** together, the one or more WNs **114** are able to approximate the CWN outputs through gradient descent.

(39) In some embodiments, the first WN **114a**, the second WN **114b**, and the third WN **114c** may comprise wavelons that utilize mother wavelets comprising an m-dimensional Mexican hat radial mother wavelet

(40) (e.g., $(x) = (1 - x^2) \exp(-\frac{x^2}{2})$).

In other embodiments, the first WN **114a**, the second WN **114b**, and the third WN **114c** may comprise wavelons that utilize mother wavelets comprising orthogonal wavelets (e.g., a Coiflet), a wavelet frame (e.g., a Morlet function, etc.), or the like. In some embodiments, each of the one or more WNs **114** may output less outputs than a preceding WN. For example, the first WN **114a** may comprise a wavelon shape of 1024×512 (e.g., 1024 inputs and 512 outputs), the second WN **114b** may comprise a wavelon shape of 12×256, and the third WN **114c** may comprise a wavelon shape of 256×128.

(41) It will be appreciated that the disclosed methods and/or block diagrams may be implemented as computer-executable instructions, in some embodiments. Thus, in one example, a computer-readable storage device (e.g., a non-transitory computer-readable medium) may store computer executable instructions that if executed by a machine (e.g., computer, processor) cause the machine to perform the disclosed methods and/or block diagrams. While executable instructions associated with the disclosed methods and/or block diagrams are described as being stored on a computer-readable storage device, it is to be appreciated that executable instructions associated with other example disclosed methods and/or block diagrams described or claimed herein may also be stored on a computer-readable storage device.

(42) FIGS. 3A-3B illustrate block diagrams showing some embodiments of a disclosed wavelet network.

(43) FIG. 3A illustrates some embodiments of a wavelet network **300** comprising a three-layer network comprising an input layer **302**, a hidden layer **306**, and an output layer **310**.

(44) The input layer **302** comprises a plurality of inputs **304a-304n**. In some embodiments, the plurality of inputs **304a-304n** may comprise n inputs received from an upstream CNN segment. The hidden layer **306** comprises a plurality of wavelons **308a-308q** (e.g., wavelet neurons). The plurality of wavelons **308a-308q** utilize a mother wavelet $\Psi_{\text{sub.q}}$ having different shift parameters and different scale parameters. In some embodiments, the mother wavelet $\Psi_{\text{sub.q}}$ may comprise an m-dimensional Mexican hat

(45) $(e.g., (x) = (1 - x^2)\exp(-\frac{x^2}{2}))$,

a Morlet wavelet

(46) $(e.g., (x) = \exp(-\frac{x^2}{2})\cos(5x))$,

or the like.

(47) The plurality of inputs **304a-304n** are selectively shifted according to wavelet shift parameters (t.sub.ij) and wavelet scale parameters (c.sub.ij) to form the plurality of wavelons **308a-308q** respectively comprising a different version of a mother wavelet $\Psi_{\text{sub.q}}$ (e.g., a wavelon is a version of a mother wavelet with a different shift and/or scaling than other wavelons). The wavelet shift parameters (t.sub.ij) are configured to shift a position (e.g., in time) of the mother wavelet $\Psi_{\text{sub.q}}$. The wavelet scale parameters (d.sub.ij) are configured to change a size (e.g., amplitude) of the mother wavelet $\Psi_{\text{sub.q}}$.

(48) The output layer **310** is a fully connected layer having a plurality of CWN outputs **312a-312c**. In some embodiments, the plurality of CWN outputs **312a-312c** may comprise c outputs. The plurality of CWN outputs **312a-312c** are respectively a function of a sum of the plurality of wavelons **308a-308q** weighted with different wavelon weight parameters (w.sub.ij). For example, CWN output **312a** is a function of a sum of a first wavelon **308a** weighted according to weight parameter w.sub.11 and a q.sup.th wavelon **308q** weighted according to weight parameter w.sub.q1 and CWN output **312c** is a function of a sum of the first wavelon **308a** weighted according to weight parameter w.sub.1c and the q.sup.th wavelon **308q** weighted according to weight parameter w.sub.qc. In some embodiments, the plurality of CWN outputs **312a-312c** are further functions of sums of a wavelon bias parameter (b.sub.p). In such embodiments, the plurality of CWN outputs **312a-312c** are a function of wavelon bias parameters (b.sub.p) added to a sum of products of different wavelon weight parameters (w.sub.ij) and the plurality of different versions of the mother wavelet.

(49) In some embodiments, the plurality of outputs **312a-312c** may be obtained according to the equation $y_{\text{sub.p}} = \sum_{i=1}^{\text{sup.q}} w_{\text{sub.ip}} \Psi(D_{\text{sub.i}}(x - t_{\text{sub.i}}) + b_{\text{sub.p}})$, for a wavelet network having n inputs ($x = [x_{\text{sub.1}}, \dots, x_{\text{sub.n}}]_{\text{sup.T}}$), q wavelons in the hidden layer **306**, and c outputs. In such embodiments, t.sub.i are translation vectors, D.sub.i are diagonal dilation matrices specified by dilation vectors d.sub.i (e.g., $D_{\text{sub.i}} = \text{diag}(d_{\text{sub.i}})$, $d_{\text{sub.i}} \in \text{custom character}_{\text{sub.+sup.n}}$).

(50) By selecting an appropriate mother wavelet and considering a sample of input/output pairs, the wavelet network **300** has four different types of parameters (e.g., weight, bias, shift, and scale) which can be optimized during a learning process. Therefore, during operation of the disclosed CWN, the wavelet network **300** will operate to train the wavelet shift parameters (t.sub.ij), the wavelet scale parameters (d.sub.ij), the wavelon bias parameters (b.sub.p), and/or the wavelon weight parameters (w.sub.ij) to determine the plurality of CWN outputs **312a-312c** in a manner that allows for classification of an input image.

(51) FIG. 3B illustrates some additional embodiments of a wavelet network **314** comprising a three-layer network comprising an input layer **302**, a hidden layer **306**, and an output layer **310**.

(52) The input layer **302** comprises a plurality of inputs **304a-304n**. The hidden layer **306** comprises a plurality of wavelons **308a-308q** (e.g., wavelet neurons) configured to utilize a mother wavelet $\Psi_{\text{sub.q}}$ having different shift parameters and weight parameters. The output layer **310** is a fully connected layer having c outputs **312a-312c**.

(53) In some embodiments, the wavelet network **314** may comprise a plurality of skip connections **316a-316m** extending between the input layer **302** and the output layer **310**. The plurality of skip connections **316a-316m** may be weighted according to skip connection weight parameters factors (v.sub.jk) (wherein i=1 to q and j=1 to n). A plurality of CWN outputs **312a-312c** are a function of weighted versions of one or more of the plurality of skip connections **316a-316m**. For example, CWN output **312a** is a function of a sum of a first wavelon **308a** weighted according to weight parameter w.sub.11, a q.sup.th wavelon weighted according to weight parameter w.sub.q1, a first

skip connection **316a** weighted according to skip connection weight parameter v_{ij} , and a second skip connection **316(m-1)** weighted according to skip connection weight parameter $v_{sub.nc}$. In some embodiments, the wavelon weight parameters may be set equal to the skip connection weight parameters (e.g., $w_{sub.ij}=v_{sub.ij}$), while in other embodiments the wavelon weight parameters may be different than the skip connection weight parameters.

(54) The plurality of skip connections **316a-316m** help preserve a gradient norm and lead to a stable back propagation via residual learning. Weighting the plurality of skip connections **316a-316m** results in an uninterrupted gradient flow between the input layer **302** and the output layer **310**, thus mitigating the vanishing gradient problem. Furthermore, the plurality of skip connections **316a-316m** may allow for faster convergence by a disclosed CWN to a lower loss function, thereby allowing the CWN to have a faster and more accurate model convergence.

(55) During operation, the wavelet network **314** will operate to train the wavelet shift parameters ($t_{sub.ij}$), the wavelet scale parameters ($d_{sub.ij}$), the wavelon bias parameters ($b_{sub.p}$), the wavelon weight parameters ($w_{sub.ij}$), and/or the skip connection weight parameters ($v_{sub.jk}$) to determine the plurality of CWN outputs **312a-312c** in a manner that allows for classification of an input image.

(56) FIG. 4 illustrates a block diagram showing some exemplary embodiments of an image analysis system **400** comprising a disclosed CWN. It will be appreciated that the values within illustrated matrices of FIG. 4 are exemplary values that are merely intended to aid the reader in understanding.

(57) The image analysis system **400** comprises a CWN **104** configured to receive an input image **102**. The input image **102** is represented as an input matrix **103** comprising rows and columns having values that respectively correspond to a value of a pixel or voxel within the input image **102**. The input matrix **103** is provided to one or more CNN segments **106**. The one or more CNN segments **106** comprise a convolution layer **108** configured to act upon the input matrix **103** with a kernel **402** to generate a feature map **404**. The kernel **402** is configured to perform a convolution on the input matrix **103** by sliding over the input matrix **103** at a stride rate. A rectification layer **110** is configured to apply a rectification function to the feature map **404** to generate a rectification map **406**. In some embodiments, the rectification function may comprise a ReLU function (e.g., a piecewise linear function that will act upon the feature map **404** to that will output a value of the feature map directly if it is positive, or otherwise zero). A pooling layer **112** is configured to perform a pooling operation on the rectification map **406**. The pooling operation down samples the rectification map **406** by summarizing a presence of features in regions of the rectification map **406**.

(58) The rectification map **406** is flattened **408** to generate CNN outputs, which are provided as inputs to an input layer **302** of one or more wavelet networks **114**. The one or more wavelet networks **114** are configured to determine a set of wavelon weight parameters ($w_{sub.ij}$), wavelet shift parameters ($s_{sub.ij}$), wavelet scale parameters ($d_{sub.ij}$), and/or wavelon bias parameters ($b_{sub.p}$), and to generate a plurality of CWN outputs **116**. The plurality of CWN outputs **116** are indicative of features within the input image **102**. In some embodiments, from the plurality of CWN outputs **116**, a predictive signature may be constructed to correspond to a prognosis. In some embodiments, the one or more wavelet networks **114** may further comprise skip connections (e.g., as shown in FIG. 3B).

(59) FIG. 5 illustrates a block diagram showing some additional embodiments of an image analysis system **500** comprising a disclosed CWN.

(60) The image analysis system **500** comprises a CWN **104** configured to receive an input image **102** as an input matrix. The CWN **104** comprises one or more CNN segments **106** that respectively include a plurality of convolution layers **108a-108c** configured to act upon the input matrix with different kernels to generate a plurality of feature maps (e.g., a first kernel is configured to operate upon the input matrix to generate a first feature map, a second kernel is configured to operate upon the input matrix to generate a second feature map, etc.). A plurality of rectification layers **110a-**

110c are configured to apply a rectification function (e.g., a ReLU function) to the plurality of feature maps to generate a plurality of rectification maps. A plurality of pooling layer **112a-112c** are configured to perform a pooling operation on the plurality of rectification maps.

(61) The outputs of the plurality of pooling layers **112a-112c** are flattened **408** and then provided to inputs of an input layer of one or more wavelet networks **114**. The one or more wavelet networks **114** are configured to determine wavelon weight parameters (w.sub.ij), wavelet shift parameters (s.sub.ij), wavelet scale parameters (d.sub.ij), and/or wavelon bias parameters (b.sub.p), and to generate a plurality of CWN outputs **116**. The plurality of CWN outputs **116** are indicative of features within the input image **102**. From the plurality of CWN outputs **116**, the input image **102** can be classified to determine to a prognosis. In some embodiments, the one or more wavelet networks **114** may further comprise skip connections (e.g., as shown in FIG. 3B).

(62) In some embodiments, the input image **102** comprises a plurality of channels that are represented by a plurality of input matrices respectively corresponding to a color. In some such embodiments, the plurality of different kernels may correspond to different colors (e.g., a first kernel may act upon a first input matrix to identify features having a first color (e.g., Red), a second kernel may act upon a second input matrix to identify features having a second color (e.g., Green), a third kernel may act upon a third input matrix to identify features having a third color (e.g., Blue), etc.), so that the plurality of different kernels form the plurality of different feature maps.

(63) It will be appreciated that the disclosed CWN may have different architectures that will utilize different numbers of convolutional segments and/or wavelet networks. FIGS. 6A-6B illustrate block diagrams showing some additional embodiments of disclosed CWN architectures. It will be appreciated that the disclosed CWN architectures are not limiting but rather are only examples of CWN architectures that may fall within the disclosed CWN.

(64) FIG. 6A illustrates a block diagram of a disclosed CWN **600** integrated within a RWCN-VGG-6 (residual wavelon convolutional network—visual geometry group) architecture.

(65) The CWN **600** comprises a RWCN-VGG-6 architecture having three CNN segments **106a-106c** and a WN **114** downstream of the three CNN segments **106a-106c**. In total, the RWCN-VGG-6 architecture comprises 3 convolution blocks **108a-108c**, 1 pooling layer **112**, and 3 wavelet networks (WNs), including additional wavelet networks **110.sub.wn1-110.sub.wn2** and wavelet network **114**. Convolution layer **108a** is configured to receive an input image **102** (e.g., as an input matrix) and to perform one or more first convolutions on the input image **102**. The output of convolution layer **108a** is flattened and provided to additional wavelet network **110.sub.wn1** as a first WN input. Additional wavelet network **110.sub.wn1** is configured to generate first WN outputs, which are provided as inputs to convolution layer **108b**. Convolution layer **108b** is configured to perform one or more second convolutions on the first WN outputs. The output of convolution layer **108b** is flattened and provided to additional wavelet network **110.sub.wn2** as a second WN input. Additional wavelet network **110.sub.wn2** is configured to generate second WN outputs, which are provided as inputs to a pooling layer **112** configured to perform a max pooling operation on the second WN outputs to generate a pooled layer. Convolution layer **108c** is configured to receive the pooled layer and to perform one or more third convolutions on the pooled layer. The output of convolution layer **108c** is flattened and provided to wavelet network **114** as a third WN input. The wavelet network **114** is configured to generate CWN outputs.

(66) In some embodiments, each of the additional wavelet networks **110.sub.wn1-110.sub.wn2** and wavelet network **114** may comprise internal skip connections (e.g., as shown in FIG. 3B) to enable residual learning. Furthermore, by building the additional wavelet networks **110.sub.wn1-110.sub.wn2** to have skip connections, later layers can learn lesser semantic information derived from initial input layers. This also mitigates information loss in size reduction blocks (e.g., pooling layer **112**).

(67) FIG. 6B illustrates a block diagram of a disclosed CWN **602** integrated within a ResNET-15 CNN architecture.

(68) The CWN **602** comprises a ResNET-15 CNN architecture having five CNN segments **106a-106e** and a WN **114** downstream of the five CNN segments **106a-106e**. In total, the ResNET-15 CNN architecture comprises 10 convolution blocks **108a-108j**, **10** batch normalization blocks **604a-604j**, **1** pooling layer **112**, and **6** wavelet networks, including additional wavelet networks (WNs) **110.sub.wn1-110.sub.wn5** and WN **114**. The additional WNs **110.sub.wn1-110.sub.wn5** are implemented as rectification layers within the five CNN segments **106a-106e**, while WN **114** is disposed downstream of the five CNN segments **106a-106e** as a final activation layer within the CWN **602**. In some embodiments, each of the wavelet networks, including additional WNs **110.sub.wn1-110.sub.wn5** and WN **114** may comprise internal skip connections (e.g., as shown in FIG. 3B) to enable residual learning.

(69) FIG. 7 illustrates a flow diagram showing some embodiments a method **700** of performing image analysis using a disclosed CWN.

(70) While the disclosed methods (e.g., methods **700**, **900**, and **1500**) are illustrated and described herein as a series of acts or events, it will be appreciated that the illustrated ordering of such acts or events are not to be interpreted in a limiting sense. For example, some acts may occur in different orders and/or concurrently with other acts or events apart from those illustrated and/or described herein. In addition, not all illustrated acts may be required to implement one or more aspects or embodiments of the description herein. Further, one or more of the acts depicted herein may be carried out in one or more separate acts and/or phases.

(71) At act **702**, imaging data is received. In some embodiments, the imaging data may comprise one or more digitized radiological images of a bowel of a patient having a bowel disease (e.g., colorectal cancer, rectal cancer, Crohn's disease, and/or the like). The imaging data may comprise one or more radiological images having a plurality of pixels or voxels, with each pixel or voxel having an associated intensity. In some embodiments, the imaging data may comprise a matrix of values that respectively correspond to an intensity of a pixel or voxel within an image.

(72) At act **704**, a convolution is performed on the imaging data to form a feature map.

(73) At act **706**, a rectification function is operated upon the feature map to generate a rectification map.

(74) At act **708**, a pooling operation is performed on the rectification map to down sample the rectification map and generate one or more pooled layers.

(75) At act **710**, the pooled layers are flattened to generate wavelet network (WN) inputs.

(76) At act **712**, a wavelet network is applied to the WN inputs to generate CWN outputs. The CWN outputs may be indicative of a classification of the imaging data.

(77) At act **714**, the CWN outputs may be used to generate a predictive signature corresponding to a patient, in some embodiments. The predictive signature may be associated with a disease response (e.g., to chemotherapy), a disease risk (e.g., a risk of recurrence, overall survival, etc.), or the like.

(78) While the disclosed CWN may be applied to a variety of images in various embodiments, it has been appreciated that the advantages of the disclosed CWN may make the disclosed CWN highly impactful for identifying predictive signatures of a treatment response via medical images (e.g., radiological images such as MRI images, MRE images, CT images, or the like). This is because the disclosed CWN is capable of identifying subtle image features (e.g., orientation and shift differences in an image) that may be important in making medical diagnoses. Such subtle orientation and shift differences could be used to distinguish between a responsive tumor and a non-responsive tumor, in some embodiments.

(79) For example, rectal cancer is a disease in which cancer cells develop in the rectum (e.g., about the last 12 centimeters of the large intestine). Over 40,000 rectal cancer patients are diagnosed annually in the United States alone. A significant clinical problem is identifying those who will or will not respond to standard-of-care chemoradiation treatment. While clinical assessments of pre-treatment MRI has not been significantly associated with pathologic complete response (pCR), the

disclosed CWN may be able to learn features associated with pCR on pre-treatment MRI and thereby suggest a more accurate prediction of a response to chemoradiation treatment in rectal cancers. This approach could bring together complementary aspects of radiomics (capturing specific texture patterns from imaging) and deep learning (intelligently learning signatures from imaging data directly) into a single framework, thus offering improved model performance and interpretability for disease characterization.

(80) FIG. 8 illustrates a block diagram showing some embodiments of a medical image analysis system **800** comprising a disclosed CWN.

(81) The medical image analysis system **800** comprises an imaging dataset **802** including imaging data from one or more radiological images **804**. In some embodiments, the imaging dataset **802** may be formed by operating a radiological imaging tool **806** upon a patient **808** to generate the one or more radiological images **804** of the patient **808**. In some embodiments, the one or more radiological images **804** may comprise images of a bowel (e.g., a colon, a rectum, etc.) of the patient **808**. In some embodiments, the patient **808** may have rectal cancer, such that the one or more radiological images **804** comprise lesions (e.g., tumors). In other embodiments, the patient **808** may have Crohn's disease, such that the one or more radiological images **804** comprise strictures.

(82) In various embodiments, the one or more radiological images **804** may comprise two-dimensional (2D) images including a plurality of pixels respectively having an intensity or three-dimensional (3D) images including a plurality of voxels respectively having an intensity. In some embodiments, the one or more radiological images **804** may comprise a volume of images including a stack of 2D images that collectively form a 3D image. The one or more radiological images **804** may be comprised within an imaging dataset **802**. In additional embodiments, a part of the one or more radiological images **804** within the imaging dataset **802** may be obtained from an on-line data base.

(83) In some embodiments, the radiological imaging tool **806** may comprise a magnetic resonance imaging (MRI) scanner configured to generate one or more radiological images **804** comprising MRI images. In other embodiments, the radiological imaging tool **806** may comprise a computed tomography (CT) scanner configured to generate one or more radiological images **804** comprising CT images, a magnetic resonance enterography (MRE) scanner configured to generate one or more radiological images **804** comprising MRE images, a computed tomography enterography (CTE) scanner configured to generate one or more radiological images **804** comprising CTE images, or the like. In some embodiments, contrast materials may be administered to the patient **808** (e.g., orally and/or intravenously) prior to imaging by the radiological imaging tool **806**.

(84) A CWN **104** is configured to operate upon the one or more radiological images **804** within the imaging dataset **802**. The CWN **104** comprises one or more CNN segments **106** and one or more WNs **114** disposed downstream of the one or more CNN segments **106**. The one or more CNN segments **106** are configured to operate upon the one or more radiological images **804** to generate one or more CNN outputs **107**. The one or more CNN outputs **107** are provided from one of the one or more CNN segments **106** to one of the one or more WNs **114**. The one or more WNs **114** are configured to decompose the one or more CNN outputs **107** according to a mother wavelet to generate one or more CWN outputs **116**. In some embodiments, an analysis tool **810** is configured to perform analysis of the one or more CWN outputs **116** to generate a predictive signature **118** of the patient **808** (e.g., a pCR or a non-pCR). The predictive signature **118** may be provided to a health care provider (e.g., by being displayed on a computer screen) and used by the health care provider to generate a prognosis and/or treatment plan to treat the patient **808**.

(85) FIG. 9 illustrates a flow diagram showing a method **900** of performing medical analysis of a radiological image using a disclosed CWN.

(86) At act **902**, an imaging dataset is formed to comprise imaging data from one or more patients having a bowel disease. In some embodiments, the one or more patients may be receiving and/or

are to receive treatment (e.g., chemotherapy) for cancer (e.g., rectal cancer). The imaging dataset comprises one or more radiological images generated from radiological scans (e.g., x-rays, CT scans, MRI scans, positron emission tomography (PET) scans, or the like) from of the patient. In some embodiments, the one or more radiological images may include one or more tumors and/or strictures within a rectum of a patient. In some embodiments, the one or more radiological images may comprise pre-treatment images.

(87) At act **904**, a CWN is applied to the imaging data to generate a plurality of CWN outputs that are relevant to a prognosis (e.g., a response to treatment) of the one or more patients. The CWN comprises one or more CNN segments and one or more WNs downstream of the one or more CNN segments. In some embodiments, act **904** may be performed according to acts **906-914**.

(88) At act **906**, a convolution is performed on the imaging data to form a feature map.

(89) At act **908**, a rectification function is applied to the feature map to form a rectification map.

(90) At act **910**, a pooling operation is performed to down-sample the rectification map and to generate one or more pooled layers.

(91) At act **912**, the one or more pooled layers are flattened to generate a plurality of CNN outputs.

(92) At act **914**, a wavelet network is applied to the plurality of CNN outputs to generate a plurality of CWN outputs.

(93) At act **916**, the CWN outputs are used to determine a predictive signature for the one or more patients. In some embodiments, the CWN outputs may be indicative of certain structural or pathological features that may be relevant to a predictive signature. For example, the CWN outputs may be used to exploit subtle differences in oriented and scaled textures between tumors which do and do not respond to chemotherapy. In some embodiments, the subtle differences may be driven by underlying pathologic phenotypes. In some embodiments, the predictive signature corresponds to one or more pathological features such as residual disease, scar tissue, fibrosis, inflammation occurring as a result of disease response, or the like.

(94) FIG. **10** illustrates a table **1000** showing example performance parameters of a disclosed DHCWN in comparison to different machine learning models operated for distinguishing a pathologic complete response (pCR) from a non-pCR.

(95) Table **1000** summarizes patient-wise classification performance for a pathologic complete response (pCR) vs. a non-pCR for a disclosed deep hybrid convolutional wavelet network (DHCWN) in comparison to a conventional convolutional neural network (CNN) and a multilayer wavelet perceptron (DWN-MLP). The disclosed DHCWN yielded the best overall performance in both training sets and hold-out validation sets, which was found to be significantly higher than alternative approaches. For example, the image-wise accuracy of the training sets for the CNN was 69.04%, for the DWN-MLP was 64.83%, and for the DHCWN was 90.67%. Furthermore, the image-wise accuracy of the hold-out validation sets for the CNN was 71.56%, for the DWN-MLP was 76.33%, and for the DHCWN was 91.17%. The patient-wise performance measures were based on aggregating the predicted classes across all 2D images sections within each patient.

(96) Furthermore, the DHCWN was found to be more computationally efficient than the DWN-MLP. For example, the DWN-MLP had a run-time of 398.37 minutes, while the DHCWN had a run-time of 112.59 minutes. The run-time of the DHCWN was marginally worse than the run-time of the CNN.

(97) FIG. **11** illustrates exemplary images **1100** showing Gradient-weighted Class Activation Mapping (Grad-CAM) heatmaps overlaid on pCR tumor ROI and non-pCR tumor ROI. Grad-CAM is a class-discriminative technique that forms a coarse localization map of important regions on an image based on class-specific gradient information flowing into a final convolution layer of a CNN. The Grad-CAM heatmaps enable interpretation of differences in network performance.

(98) The exemplary images **1100** comprise representative Grad-CAM heatmaps of pCR patients **1102** and non-pCR patients **1104**. Within the Grad-CAM maps, warmer colors (e.g., red, yellow, etc.) indicate stronger network responses and primary locations of interest for a network. As red

regions correspond to high scores in the Grad-CAM visualization, a tumor region of interest appears to be the location of primary focus by a DHCWN in pCR patients **1102**. By comparison, the network appears to localize the lumen-wall boundary in non-pCR patients **1104**, which may be related to known tumor growth differences between response groups. Therefore, the exemplary images **1100** illustrate that the disclosed DHCWN is able to consistently identify relevant locations within a region of interest for pCR classification.

(99) In some embodiments, a Grad-CAM heatmap corresponding to CWN outputs of a disclosed CWN may be compared to a pathology image (e.g., an MRI pathology) to determine a correlation between the CWN outputs and pathological features (e.g., anatomic features of the pathology image). Because the CWN outputs are able to capture complicated patterns within a digitized image, the CWN outputs may be able to achieve a highly accurate correlation between relevant locations within a region of interest and the pathological features. The highly accurate correlation can allow for the disclosed CWN to identify pathological features (e.g., residual disease, scar tissue, fibrosis, inflammation occurring as a result of disease response, etc.) that contribute to a predictive signature of a disease. In some embodiments, the identification of such pathological features can be used to further improve the predictive signature.

(100) FIGS. **12A-12B** illustrate tables, **1200** and **1212**, showing example performance parameters of disclosed DHCWNs having different Mother wavelets in comparison to different machine learning models operated to distinguish a pCR from a non-pCR. In some embodiments, the different machine learning models were trained over 350 epochs, with a batch size of 64, a learning rate of 0.0001, a cross-entropy loss function, and the Adam optimization function (weight decay=0.0001).

(101) FIG. **12A** shows a table **1200** that summarizes patient-wise classification performance for 2D machine learning models operated to distinguish pCR from non-pCR.

(102) Table **1200** illustrates performance parameters for a CNN **1202**, for a DWN-MLP **1204** having a mother wavelet comprising a Mexican hat, for a DWN-MLP **1206** having a mother wavelet comprising a Morlet function, for a disclosed DHCWN **1208** having a mother wavelet comprising a Mexican hat, and for a disclosed DHCWN **1210** having a mother wavelet comprising a Morlet function. For each of the different machine learning models, table **1200** shows a runtime (measured in minutes), accuracies for discovery sets (e.g., training sets) and hold-out validation sets (e.g., testing sets), and AUCs (area-under curve) for the discovery sets and the hold-out validation sets.

(103) Table **1200** illustrates that the disclosed DHCWN **1208** and disclosed DHCWN **1210** provide for a significant improvement of both accuracy and AUC over the CNN **1202**, the DWN-MLP **1204**, and the DWN-MLP **1206**. In some embodiments, the improvement may be in a range of between approximately 20% and approximately 30% for both the accuracy and the AUC.

Furthermore, the disclosed DHCWN **1208** and disclosed DHCWN **1210** provide for a significantly higher computational efficiency (e.g., a lower run-time) than the DWN-MLP **1204** and DWN-MLP **1206** and a computational efficiency (e.g., runtime) that is marginally lower than the CNN **1202**.

(104) Table **1200** also shows that the DHCWN **1210** using a mother wavelet comprising a Morlet function provides for improved accuracy and AUC in comparison to the DHCWN **1208** using a mother wavelet comprising a Mexican hat function. This suggests the disclosed DHCWN architecture may be able to exploit more complex texture patterns by changing a mother wavelet.

(105) FIG. **12B** shows a table **1212** that summarizes patient-wise classification performance for 3D machine learning models operated to distinguish pCR from non-pCR.

(106) Table **1212** illustrates performance parameters for a regular CNN **1214**, for a DWN-MLP **1216** having a mother wavelet comprising a Mexican hat, for a DWN-MLP **1218** having a mother wavelet comprising a Morlet function, for a disclosed DHCWN **1220** having a mother wavelet comprising a Mexican hat, and for a disclosed DHCWN **1222** having a mother wavelet comprising a Morlet function. For each of the different machine learning models, table **1212** shows a runtime,

accuracies for discovery sets (e.g., training sets) and hold-out validation sets, and AUCs for the discovery sets and the hold-out validation sets.

(107) Table **1212** illustrates that the disclosed DHCWN **1220** and the disclosed DHCWN **1222** provide for a significant improvement of both accuracy and AUC over the CNN **1214**, the DWN-MLP **1216**, and the DWN-MLP **1218**. In some embodiments, the improvement may be in a range of between approximately 20% and approximately 30% for both the accuracy and the AUC.

Furthermore, the disclosed DHCWN **1220** and the disclosed DHCWN **1222** provide for a significantly higher computational efficiency (than DWN-MLP **1216** and DWN-MLP **1218** and a computational efficiency that is marginally lower than the CNN **1214**. In some embodiments, Pairwise Wilcoxon testing with multiple comparison correction may be used to assess significant differences in accuracies and AUCs between DHCWN and each of the CNN and the DWN-MLP.

(108) FIG. **13A** illustrates exemplary images **1300** showing Grad-CAM heatmaps overlaid on pCR tumor ROI and non-pCR tumor ROI.

(109) The exemplary images **1300** illustrate representative Grad-CAM visualizations for 2D models comparing heatmaps between DHCWN, CNN, and DWN-MLP networks. The representative Grad-CAM heatmaps are overlaid on pCR tumor ROI (top row) and non-pCR tumor ROI (bottom row). Warmer colors (e.g., red, yellow) indicate stronger network responses and primary locations of attention for the network. The wavelet function within DHCWN was the Morlet function

(110) As red regions correspond to high scores in the Grad-CAM visualization, the tumor ROI appears to be the location of primary focus by the DHCWN in pCR patients. By comparison, CNN and DWN exhibit more blue regions in their heatmap suggesting misclassification patterns and poorer performance of these networks in identifying pCR patients (e.g., patients that experience pCR) and non-pCR patients (e.g., patients that experience non-pCR). Non-pCR patients show different trends in blue regions for CNN and DWN-MLP, further indicating these networks paid less attention to certain portions of the tumor. The DHCWN appears to have paid more consistent attention to every part of the annotated tumor across both pCR and non-pCR patients (e.g., having minimal blue and almost uniform red throughout).

(111) FIG. **13B** illustrates exemplary images **1302** showing SHAP maps overlaid on MR images for a disclosed RWCN (RWCN-ResNet-15) and a CNN model (ResNet-50). The exemplary images **1302** show pCR (e.g., low-risk) patients in the top-row and non-pCR (e.g., high-risk) patients in the bottom row. Images **1304** correspond to pre-treatment images of a patient having rectal cancer prior to neoadjuvant chemoradiation (nCRT). Images **1306** correspond to post-treatment images of a patient having rectal cancer after nCRT. Images **1308** correspond to images of a patient having Crohn's disease. In images **1304**, regions outlined in green are a tumor, regions outlined in yellow are a lumen, and regions outlined in pink a rectal wall. In images **1306**, regions outlined in green are a tumor and regions outlined in yellow are a lumen. In images **1308**, regions outlined in green are a terminal ileum.

(112) The RWCN (RWCN-ResNet-15) appears to have correctly and more homogeneously assigned target class relevance to annotated input regions in non-pCR patients (e.g., more deep red shading within green outlines in the bottom row) in comparison to pCR patients (e.g., top row shows more consistent blue shading within green outlines). Further, the ResNet-50 assigned mixed importance to annotated regions (e.g., lighter shading and mixture of red and blue within all outlines), suggesting lower model confidence as well as suboptimal learning of class-specific responses.

(113) FIG. **14** illustrates a table **1400** showing exemplary performance parameters for disclosed RWCNs in comparison to different machine learning models architectures in distinguishing pCR from non-pCR for different diseases.

(114) Table **1400** summarizes classification accuracy in both discovery sets (e.g., training sets) and hold-out validation sets (e.g., testing sets) for a RWCN-VGG-6 architecture **1402** (e.g., as shown in

FIG. 5A) without skip connections, for a RWCN-VGG-6 architecture **1404** (e.g., as shown in FIG. 5A) with skip connections, for a RWCN-ResNet-15 architecture **1406** (e.g., as shown in FIG. 5B) without skip connections, for a RWCN-ResNet-15 architecture **1408** (e.g., as shown in FIG. 5B) with skip connections, for a VGG-16 architecture **1410**, for a VGG-16 architecture **1412**, for a ResNet-18 architecture **1414**, and for a ResNet 50 architecture **1416**.

(115) As shown in table **1400**, the RWCN-ResNet-15 **1406** with identity skip connections was found to yield significantly higher model performance in both discovery sets and hold-out validation sets compared to any alternative RWCN based model as well as all of VGG-16, VGG-19, ResNet-18, and ResNet-50. Furthermore, the VGG-16 architecture, the VGG-16 architecture, the ResNet-18 architecture, and the ResNet 50 architecture are seen to perform equivalently to each other, suggesting that any improvements in performance may be a result of adapting them to incorporate WNs with skip connections. Further, RWCNs using WNs without skip connections ($vp=0$) perform significantly worse than CNN-based strategies, suggesting the importance of residual learning in these tasks. Notably, all RWCN models exhibit markedly lower runtimes and faster convergence than any CNN model, in addition to using significantly fewer parameters than ResNet and VGG architectures.

(116) FIG. **15** illustrates a flow diagram of some additional embodiments of a method **1500** of generating and applying a disclosed CWN to a patient.

(117) The method **1500** comprises a training phase **1502** and an application phase **1526**. The training phase **1502** is configured to train a CWN to generate a plurality of CWN outputs that are indicative of a prognosis (e.g., of a pCR response or a non-pCR response). In some embodiments, the training phase **1502** may be performed according to acts **1504-1524**.

(118) At act **1504**, an imaging dataset is provided and/or formed to comprise a plurality of radiological images. In various embodiments, the plurality of radiological images may comprise pre-treatment images from patients having a bowel disease (e.g., rectal cancer and/or Crohn's disease). In some embodiments, the plurality of radiological images may be obtained from different institutions (e.g., different hospitals, clinics, universities, etc.). In some embodiments, the imaging dataset may comprise more than 100 radiological images, more than 150 radiological images, more than 200 radiological images, etc. In some embodiments, the imaging dataset may comprise 153 pre-treatment rectal cancer MRI scans. In some embodiments, the imaging data may comprise T2 weighted (T2w) MRI scans.

(119) In some embodiments, each of the plurality of radiological images has a corresponding ground truth. In some embodiments, histopathologic tumor regression grade (TRG) assessment of an excised surgical specimen (obtained as per standard-of-care in rectal cancer treatment) was used as the ground truth for pathologic tumor response to nCRT where TRG0 (0% viable tumor cells remaining) was considered as pCR while TRG1-3 were labeled non-pCR.

(120) In some embodiments, the plurality of radiological images may be subjected to one or more quality enhancement operations. For example, in some embodiments the one or more quality enhancement operations may comprise subjecting the plurality of radiological images (e.g., MRI scans) to resampling to ensure a consistent voxel resolution across the cohort (trilinear, $1\times1\times1$ mm). In some embodiments, the one or more quality enhancement operations may comprise using available radiologist annotations of an entire tumor ROI to estimate bounding boxes to span a lesion after connected component analysis to omit ROIs smaller than 20 pixels. Based on the average size of tumor ROIs across the cohort, tumor bounding boxes may be resized (e.g., to 62×62 and $62\times62\times62$ pixels in 2D and 3D, respectively).

(121) At act **1506**, the plurality of radiological images within the imaging dataset are separated into one or more discovery sets (e.g., training sets) and one or more hold-out validation sets (e.g., testing sets). In some embodiments, the plurality of radiological images be separated in a manner that causes approximately 70% of radiological images to be placed within the one or more discovery sets and 30% of the radiological images to be placed within the one or more hold-out

validation sets.

(122) At act **1508**, a CWN is operated upon imaging data within one or more discovery sets to generate a plurality of CWN outputs for the discovery sets. The plurality of CWN outputs are indicative of a prognosis (e.g., of a pCR response or a non-pCR response). In some embodiments, the CWN is configured to operate upon the imaging data according to acts **1510-1518**.

(123) At act **1510**, a convolution may be performed on the imaging data within the one or more discovery sets to generate a feature map. The convolution may be performed by applying a kernel to the imaging data.

(124) At act **1512**, a rectification function is applied to the feature map to form a rectification map.

(125) At act **1514**, a pooling operation is performed to down-sample the rectification map and to form one or more pooled layers.

(126) At act **1516**, the one or more pooled layers are flattened to generate a plurality of CNN outputs.

(127) At act **1518**, a wavelet network is applied to the plurality of CNN outputs to generate a plurality of CWN outputs.

(128) At act **1520**, the plurality of CWN outputs from the discovery sets are validated. In some embodiments, the plurality of CWN outputs from the discovery sets may be validated by comparing the plurality of CNN outputs to a corresponding ground truth.

(129) At act **1522**, the CWN is operated upon imaging data within one or more hold-out validation sets to generate a plurality of CWN outputs for the hold-out validation sets. In some embodiments, the CWN is configured to operate upon the imaging data within the hold-out validation sets according to acts **1510-1518**.

(130) At act **1524**, the plurality of CWN outputs from the hold-out validation sets are validated. In some embodiments, the plurality of CWN outputs from the hold-out validation sets may be validated by comparing an output of the CWN to a corresponding ground truth.

(131) The application phase **1526** is configured to utilize the CWN that was trained in the training phase **1502** on one or more additional radiological images, which are taken from an additional patient suspected of having a bowel disease (e.g., rectal cancer and/or Chron's disease). In some embodiments, the application phase **1526** may be performed according to acts **1528-1530**.

(132) At act **1528**, an additional imaging data is obtained from an additional patient. The additional imaging data may comprise an additional radiological image that is a pre-treatment image of the patient.

(133) At act **1530**, the additional imaging data is operated upon by the CWN to generate one or more additional CWN outputs.

(134) At act **1532**, a predictive signature is determined from the one or more additional CWN outputs.

(135) FIG. **16** illustrates a block diagram of some embodiments of an apparatus **1600** comprising a CWN that is configured to determine a prognosis for a patient.

(136) The apparatus **1600** is configured to generate a prognosis for a patient based upon one or more pre-treatment radiological images. In some embodiments, the apparatus **1600** may be coupled to a radiological imaging tool **806** configured to act upon a patient **808** having or suspected to have rectal cancer and/or Crohn's disease. In various embodiments, the radiological imaging tool **806** may comprise an MRI scanner, an MRE scanner, a CT scanner, a CTE scanner, or the like.

(137) The apparatus **1600** comprises a processor **1604** and a memory **1606**. The processor **1604** can, in various embodiments, comprise circuitry such as, but not limited to, one or more single-core or multi-core processors. The processor **1604** can include any combination of general-purpose processors and dedicated processors (e.g., graphics processors, application processors, etc.). The processor(s) **1604** can be coupled with and/or can comprise memory (e.g., memory **1606**) or storage and can be configured to execute instructions stored in the memory **1606** or storage to enable various apparatus, applications, or operating systems to perform operations and/or methods

discussed herein.

(138) Memory **1606** can be configured to store an imaging dataset **802** comprising one or more radiological images **804** (e.g., CTE images, MRE images, etc.) from one or more patients. Each of the one or more radiological images can have a plurality of pixels or voxels, each pixel or voxel having an associated intensity. In some embodiments, memory **1606** can store one or more radiological images as one or more discovery set(s) for training a disclosed CWN and/or one or more hold-out validation sets for validating the disclosed CWN.

(139) The analysis apparatus **1602** also comprises an input/output (I/O) interface **1608** (e.g., associated with one or more I/O devices), a display **1610**, a set of circuits **1612**, and an interface **1614** that connects the processor **1604**, the memory **1606**, the I/O interface **1608**, the display **1610**, and the set of circuits **1612**. The I/O interface **1608** can be configured to transfer data between the memory **1606**, the processor **1604**, the set of circuits **1612**, and external devices, for example, a medical imaging device such as a CTE scanner, an MRE scanner, or the like.

(140) The set of circuits **1612** can comprise one or more CNN segment circuits **1615** and one or more wavelet network circuits **1616**. In some embodiments, the set of circuits **1612** may comprise hardware components. The set of circuits **1612** are configured to access the imaging dataset **802**. The one or more CNN segment circuits **1615** are configured to operate upon the one or more radiological images **804** with CNN algorithms **1618** stored in the memory **1606** to generate a plurality of CNN outputs. The one or more wavelet network circuits **1616** are configured to operate upon the plurality of CNN outputs with one or more WN algorithms **1620** to generate CWN outputs **116**. In some additional embodiments, the set of circuits **1612** may further comprise a predictive signature generator circuit **1622**. The predictive signature generator circuit **1622** is configured to generate a predictive signature relating to a disease of a patient.

(141) Therefore, the present disclosure relates to a convolutional wavelet network (CWN) that utilizes both deep learning (e.g., convolutional neural networks) and wavelet networks to generate a prognosis from a digitized image of a patient.

(142) In some embodiments, the present disclosure relates to a non-transitory computer-readable medium storing computer-executable instructions that, when executed, cause a processor to perform operations, including forming an imaging dataset having imaging data corresponding to one or more radiological images of a patient with a bowel disease; operating upon the imaging data with one or more convolutional neural network (CNN) segments configured to generate a plurality of CNN outputs, the one or more CNN segments respectively having a convolution layer configured to perform a convolution on the imaging data; applying a wavelet network to the plurality of CNN outputs to generate a plurality of convolution wavelet network (CWN) outputs, the wavelet network being configured to decompose the plurality of CNN outputs according to a mother wavelet; and constructing a predictive signature associated with disease response or risk based on the plurality of CWN outputs.

(143) In other embodiments, the present disclosure relates to a method of image analysis, including forming an imaging dataset having imaging data corresponding to one or more pre-treatment radiological images of a patient with a bowel disease; performing a convolution on the imaging data to form a feature map; performing a rectification function on the feature map to form a rectification map; performing a pooling operation on the rectification map to form a plurality of CNN outputs; applying a wavelet network to the plurality of CNN outputs, the wavelet network being configured to decompose the plurality of CNN outputs into a plurality of different versions of a mother wavelet respectively having different wavelet shift parameters and wavelet scale parameters, and to generate a plurality of CWN outputs from the plurality of different versions of the mother wavelet; and constructing a predictive signature for the patient based on the plurality of CWN outputs, the predictive signature being associated with disease response or risk.

(144) In other embodiments, the present disclosure relates to an image analysis system, including a memory configured to store an imaging dataset having imaging data corresponding to one or more

pre-treatment radiological images of a patient having a bowel disease; one or more convolutional neural network (CNN) segments configured to perform one or more convolutions on the imaging data to generate a plurality of CNN outputs; a wavelet network disposed downstream of the one or more CNN segments, the wavelet network being configured to decompose the plurality of CNN outputs into a plurality of wavelons and to generate a plurality of CWN outputs by summing differently weighted versions of the plurality of wavelons, the plurality of wavelons respectively including different versions of a mother wavelet that has been shifted and scaled according to different wavelet shift parameters and different wavelet scale parameters; and a predictive signature generator configured to generate a predictive signature relating to the bowel disease of the patient.

(145) Examples herein can include subject matter such as an apparatus, a digital whole slide scanner, a CT system, an MRI system, a personalized medicine system, a CADx system, a processor, a system, circuitry, a method, means for performing acts, steps, or blocks of the method, at least one machine-readable medium including executable instructions that, when performed by a machine (e.g., a processor with memory, an application-specific integrated circuit (ASIC), a field programmable gate array (FPGA), or the like) cause the machine to perform acts of the method or of an apparatus or system, according to embodiments and examples described.

(146) References to “one embodiment”, “an embodiment”, “one example”, and “an example” indicate that the embodiment(s) or example(s) so described may include a particular feature, structure, characteristic, property, element, or limitation, but that not every embodiment or example necessarily includes that particular feature, structure, characteristic, property, element or limitation. Furthermore, repeated use of the phrase “in one embodiment” does not necessarily refer to the same embodiment, though it may.

(147) “Computer-readable storage device”, as used herein, refers to a device that stores instructions or data. “Computer-readable storage device” does not refer to propagated signals. A computer-readable storage device may take forms, including, but not limited to, non-volatile media, and volatile media. Non-volatile media may include, for example, optical disks, magnetic disks, tapes, and other media. Volatile media may include, for example, semiconductor memories, dynamic memory, and other media. Common forms of a computer-readable storage device may include, but are not limited to, a floppy disk, a flexible disk, a hard disk, a magnetic tape, other magnetic medium, an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), a compact disk (CD), other optical medium, a random access memory (RAM), a read only memory (ROM), a memory chip or card, a memory stick, and other media from which a computer, a processor or other electronic device can read.

(148) “Circuit”, as used herein, includes but is not limited to hardware, firmware, software in execution on a machine, or combinations of each to perform a function(s) or an action(s), or to cause a function or action from another logic, method, or system. A circuit may include a software controlled microprocessor, a discrete logic (e.g., ASIC), an analog circuit, a digital circuit, a programmed logic device, a memory device containing instructions, and other physical devices. A circuit may include one or more gates, combinations of gates, or other circuit components. Where multiple logical circuits are described, it may be possible to incorporate the multiple logical circuits into one physical circuit. Similarly, where a single logical circuit is described, it may be possible to distribute that single logical circuit between multiple physical circuits.

(149) To the extent that the term “includes” or “including” is employed in the detailed description or the claims, it is intended to be inclusive in a manner similar to the term “comprising” as that term is interpreted when employed as a transitional word in a claim.

(150) Throughout this specification and the claims that follow, unless the context requires otherwise, the words ‘comprise’ and ‘include’ and variations such as ‘comprising’ and ‘including’ will be understood to be terms of inclusion and not exclusion. For example, when such terms are used to refer to a stated integer or group of integers, such terms do not imply the exclusion of any other integer or group of integers.

(151) To the extent that the term “or” is employed in the detailed description or claims (e.g., A or B) it is intended to mean “A or B or both”. When the applicants intend to indicate “only A or B but not both” then the term “only A or B but not both” will be employed. Thus, use of the term “or” herein is the inclusive, and not the exclusive use. See, Bryan A. Garner, A Dictionary of Modern Legal Usage 624 (2d. Ed. 1995).

(152) While example systems, methods, and other embodiments have been illustrated by describing examples, and while the examples have been described in considerable detail, it is not the intention of the applicants to restrict or in any way limit the scope of the appended claims to such detail. It is, of course, not possible to describe every conceivable combination of components or methodologies for purposes of describing the systems, methods, and other embodiments described herein. Therefore, the invention is not limited to the specific details, the representative apparatus, and illustrative examples shown and described. Thus, this application is intended to embrace alterations, modifications, and variations that fall within the scope of the appended claims.

Claims

1. A non-transitory computer-readable medium storing computer-executable instructions that, when executed, cause a processor to perform operations, comprising: forming an imaging dataset comprising imaging data corresponding to one or more radiological images of a patient having a bowel disease; operating upon the imaging data with one or more convolutional neural network (CNN) segments configured to generate a plurality of CNN outputs, wherein the one or more CNN segments respectively comprise a convolution layer configured to perform a convolution on the imaging data; applying a wavelet network to the plurality of CNN outputs to generate a plurality of convolution wavelet network (CWN) outputs, wherein the wavelet network is configured to decompose the plurality of CNN outputs according to a mother wavelet; and constructing a predictive signature associated with disease response or risk based on the plurality of CWN outputs.
2. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 1, wherein operating upon the imaging data with the one or more CNN segments comprises: performing the convolution on the imaging data to form a feature map; operating upon the feature map with a rectification function to form one or more rectification maps; performing a pooling operation on the one or more rectification maps to form a plurality of pooled layers; and flattening the plurality of pooled layers to form the plurality of CNN outputs.
3. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 2, wherein the wavelet network comprises four or more hidden layers.
4. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 2, wherein the rectification function is an additional wavelet network.
5. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 1, wherein the wavelet network comprises: an input layer configured to receive the plurality of CNN outputs; a hidden layer comprising a plurality of wavelons respectively having different versions of the mother wavelet; and an output layer comprising the plurality of CWN outputs, the plurality of CWN outputs being a function of a sum of different wavelon weight parameters of the plurality of wavelons.
6. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 5, wherein the different versions of the mother wavelet within the plurality of wavelons are formed by applying different wavelet shift parameters and different wavelet scale parameters to the mother wavelet.
7. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 5, wherein the plurality of CWN outputs are a function of a wavelon bias parameter added to the sum of the different wavelon weight parameters of the plurality of wavelons.
8. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 5, wherein the wavelet network comprises one or more skip connections extending between the input layer and the output layer, the

plurality of CWN outputs being a function of weighted versions of the one or more skip connections.

9. The non-transitory computer readable medium of claim 1, wherein the predictive signature corresponds to one or more of residual disease, scar tissue, fibrosis, and inflammation occurring as a result of disease response.
10. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 1, further comprising: utilizing the plurality of CWN outputs to determine if a tumor will have a pathologic complete response (pCR) or a non-pCR to chemotherapy.
11. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 1, wherein the plurality of CWN outputs are a function of a wavelet shift parameter, a wavelet scale parameter, a wavelon bias parameter, and a wavelon weight parameter.
12. A method of image analysis, comprising: forming an imaging dataset comprising imaging data corresponding to one or more pre-treatment radiological images of a patient having a bowel disease; performing a convolution on the imaging data to form a feature map; performing a rectification function on the feature map to form a rectification map; performing a pooling operation on the rectification map to form a plurality of CNN outputs; applying a wavelet network to the plurality of CNN outputs, wherein the wavelet network is configured to decompose the plurality of CNN outputs into a plurality of different versions of a mother wavelet respectively having different wavelet shift parameters and wavelet scale parameters, and to generate a plurality of CWN outputs from the plurality of different versions of the mother wavelet; and constructing a predictive signature for the patient based on the plurality of CWN outputs, the predictive signature being associated with disease response or risk.
13. The method of claim 12, wherein the plurality of CWN outputs are a function of wavelon bias parameters added to a sum of products of different wavelon weight parameters and the plurality of different versions of the mother wavelet.
14. The method of claim 12, wherein the wavelet network comprises one or more skip connections extending between an input layer comprising the plurality of CNN outputs and an output layer comprising the plurality of CWN outputs, the plurality of CWN outputs being a function of weighted versions of the one or more skip connections.
15. The method of claim 12, wherein the rectification function is an additional wavelet network.
16. The method of claim 12, further comprising: utilizing the plurality of CWN outputs to determine a treatment plan for the patient comprising pharmaceutical therapy or surgery.
17. An image analysis system, comprising: a memory configured to store an imaging dataset comprising imaging data corresponding to one or more pre-treatment radiological images of a patient having a bowel disease; one or more convolutional neural network (CNN) segments configured to perform one or more convolutions on the imaging data to generate a plurality of CNN outputs; a wavelet network disposed downstream of the one or more CNN segments, the wavelet network being configured to decompose the plurality of CNN outputs into a plurality of wavelons and to generate a plurality of CWN outputs by summing differently weighted versions of the plurality of wavelons, wherein the plurality of wavelons respectively comprise different versions of a mother wavelet that has been shifted and scaled according to different wavelet shift parameters and different wavelet scale parameters; and a predictive signature generator configured to generate a predictive signature relating to the bowel disease of the patient.
18. The image analysis system of claim 17, wherein the wavelet network comprises: an input layer configured to receive the plurality of CNN outputs; a hidden layer comprising the plurality of wavelons; and an output layer comprising the plurality of CWN outputs.
19. The image analysis system of claim 18, wherein the wavelet network comprises one or more skip connections extending between the input layer and the output layer, the plurality of CWN outputs being a function of weighted versions of the one or more skip connections.
20. The non-transitory computer readable medium of claim 17, wherein the predictive signature

corresponds to one or more of residual disease, scar tissue, fibrosis, and inflammation occurring as a result of disease response.
